

Uddannelsesmuligheder i Danmark



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from El Salvador. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great question! First of all, congratulations on finishing primary school — that's a big step. Since you're in Denmark and you're 16, you're now at a point where you can choose between different types of upper secondary education, depending on your interests, strengths, and future plans.

Here's a guide to help you think through your options:

Main types of upper secondary education in Denmark

1 Gymnasiale uddannelser (academic upper secondary programmes)

These prepare you for higher education (university, college). Options include:

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – General upper secondary education with a broad range of subjects (good if you want flexibility and like academic work)
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** – Focus on business, economics, and languages
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** – Focus on technology, science, and technical subjects
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – Shorter (2 years), often chosen by students who want a more practical academic programme or had a break after primary school

2 Erhvervsuddannelser (vocational education and training, VET)

- Combines school and apprenticeship (praktik) in a company
- Good if you prefer practical, hands-on work and want to get a job faster (e.g., carpenter, electrician, chef, hairdresser)
- You can still take an EUX (a combination that gives both a vocational qualification and general upper secondary diploma for university access)

How to choose?

Ask yourself:

- ✓ Do I like academic studies, or do I prefer practical work?
- ✓ Do I already have a career in mind (e.g., engineer, teacher, chef, entrepreneur)?
- ✓ Am I motivated by hands-on experience or classroom learning?
- ✓ Would I like to go to university later, or am I more interested in working earlier?

A recommendation for you

Since you:

- are fluent in Danish,
- have a multicultural background (which can be a big asset in business, languages, or international fields),
- and are just starting to explore options,

If you enjoy academic subjects and want to keep doors open:

Consider **STX** (broad) or **HHX** (if you're interested in business/economics, where your language skills could be a strength).

If you prefer technical or practical work:

Look at **HTX** (if you like science/tech) or a **VET/EUX** programme in a field that interests you (e.g. IT, mechanics, gastronomy).

 **Tip:** Visit *uddannelsesmesser* (education fairs), talk to school counsellors (*studievejleder*), or try a *brobygning* (trial period) — this can give you a feel for different programmes.

Final thought

There's no one "best" path — think about what excites you, and remember that in Denmark, it's common (and okay!) to switch paths if you discover new interests.

If you'd like, tell me more about:

- What subjects you enjoy
- What kind of work you can see yourself doing
- Whether you're thinking about university

...and I can give you a more tailored recommendation! 